

Howard Chen

Brooklyn, NY 11220 | (732) 725-9888 | howarch@umich.edu | <https://howarc.github.io/web/>

EDUCATION

University of Michigan | GPA: 3.9/4.0

Ann Arbor, MI

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | Data Science Minor

Expected Dec 2025

- **Coursework:** Game Development, Data Structures & Algorithms, Machine Learning, Principles of Software Engineering, 3D Technical Art and Animation, Practical Data Science, Information Retrieval & Web Search
- **Honors:** Helfman Scholarship, Anikstein Family Scholarship

EXPERIENCE

C-Stun Studios

Co-Founder and Lead Game Developer

June 2024 - Present

- Led a team of 4 through the full game development lifecycle, overseeing design and scripting, with the studio's first title slated to release in Q4 2025
- Engineered the core gameplay loop, featuring a roguelite playstyle and maps with structural procedural generation
- Implemented a flexible progression system, featuring 30+ unique upgrades, that foster meaningful decision-making
- Developed a reusable cutscene framework incorporating camera sequencing and timeline scripting, which reduced setup time per scene and powered 6+ cinematic sequences
- Modeled 20+ custom 3D game-ready assets and animations from Blender, and integrated into Roblox Studio
- Built a developer testbed framework to enable efficient playtesting and reducing debugging overhead

PROJECTS

EchoTrace

Lead Game Developer

Feb 2025 - Apr 2025

- Spearheaded the design and implementation of a highly scalable deckbuilding system in C#, creating the underlying framework that facilitated rapid prototyping and integration of 40+ unique card abilities
- Completed five public playtest cycles, leveraging player feedback and behavioral data to iteratively refine gameplay through agile development practices
- Produced, scripted, and edited the official game trailer with recruited voice talent, showcased during the team's final presentation to 200+ attendees and later released online, garnering 100 additional views

Save the Earth

Solo Developer

Feb 2025 - Mar 2025

- Created 6 modular levels for a mouse-based reaction game where players clear asteroids from crashing into Earth
- Developed 2 supplemental mechanics to enrich level interaction and scale gameplay challenge throughout progression

Zelda NES Dungeon Remake

Lead Game Developer

Jan 2025 - Feb 2025

- Modernized first dungeon tileset from *The Legend of Zelda (NES)* in Unity, recreating map layout, enemy AI behaviors, and player arsenal to preserve retro feel
- Introduced extra content involving a novel circuit-based mechanism supplemented through 5 puzzle interactions

RESEARCH

Duke Lemur Center

Senior Research Assistant

Durham, NC

May 2023 - Jul 2023

- Implemented data-processing scripts in R and Python, automating trial execution workflows and improving efficiency
- Digitized 100+ handwritten datasheets into standardized Excel and Adobe formats, ensuring clean data integration and eliminating manual transcription errors

SKILLS

Languages: C++, C#, Python, Luau (Roblox), R, SQL

Game Engines: Unity, Unreal, Roblox Studio

Tools & Software: Blender, Jira, Tableau